

PLASTICS DISTRIBUTION · AEROSPACE & INDUSTRIAL

A leading U.S. plastics distributor

This case study highlights how FreightPOP partnered with a leading U.S. plastics distributor to revolutionize their logistics operations during a critical time. Faced with the dual challenges of managing surging demand for protective equipment and addressing inefficiencies in their supply chain, the distributor turned to FreightPOP for a solution. Discover how FreightPOP's cloud-based TMS delivered full supply chain visibility, cost savings, and operational efficiency to support their operations.



ABOUT

About the company

The company is a trusted leader in the distribution of plastics, serving key industries such as airline and aerospace. With decades of experience, they have established a reputation for delivering high-quality products and exceptional service.

In addition to plastics, their portfolio includes ceramics, laminates, composites, and specialty alloys. This diversification allows them to meet the complex needs of a wide array of clients, from industrial manufacturers to medical suppliers.

MATERIALS PORTFOLIO

01

Plastics & composites

02

Ceramics & laminates

03

Specialty alloys

CONTEXT

During COVID-19

During the COVID-19 pandemic, the business faced unprecedented demand for protective equipment. To address this surge and ensure efficient supply chain operations, they needed a robust logistics solution that could handle the increased volume and provide full visibility into their shipping process.

CHALLENGES & SOLUTIONS

The challenges & FreightPOP solutions

BEFORE

01

Limited Supply Chain Visibility

Their previous TMS only supported outbound LTL shipments, preventing full multimodal visibility across air, ocean, LTL, and parcel.

02

Inability to Compare Modes

They could not view parcel rates alongside LTL rates on a single platform, which made cost optimization difficult.

03

Communication Bottlenecks

Thin visibility and no automation created delays between sales and purchasing — slow order tracking and customer updates.

04

Urgency of Deployment

As demand for protective equipment surged, they needed a fast, effective TMS to absorb rising shipment volumes.

WITH FREIGHTPOP

01

Enhanced Multimodal Visibility

FreightPOP manages and tracks shipments across every mode — air, ocean, LTL, inbound, and outbound — on a single platform.

02

Integrated Rate Comparison

Parcel and LTL rates sit side by side, optimizing carrier selection and reducing shipping costs on every lane.

03

Automation

Pre-alerts linked to PO numbers keep sales and purchasing in sync, and let salespeople and customers track shipments in real time.

04

Rapid Deployment

The cloud-based platform rolled out across all U.S. locations, with custom programming for their unique carrier requirements.

BY THE NUMBERS

A demand spike that outgrew a single-mode TMS

GLOBAL PLASTIC USAGE



During the COVID-19 pandemic, global plastic usage increased by approximately 5% — millions of additional tons of plastic produced compared with previous years.

PREVIOUS TMS

1 mode — outbound LTL

Everything outside outbound LTL lived outside the system: air, ocean, parcel, and all inbound freight were tracked by hand.

WITH FREIGHTPOP

4+ modes, inbound & outbound

Air, ocean, LTL, and parcel rate side by side in one platform — with their own negotiated rates applied in both directions.

RESULTS

The results

01

Full Supply Chain Visibility

The customer gained visibility into both inbound and outbound shipments, enabling better decision-making.

02

Improved Rate Control

They can now control and compare rates for both inbound and outbound shipments using their own negotiated carrier rates.

03

Enhanced Internal Communication

Automated notifications and alerts reduced bottlenecks between the sales and purchasing departments.

04

Efficient Deployment

A smooth, fast rollout across all U.S. locations, even accommodating custom programming.

NET EFFECT

Immediate cost savings, faster internal handoffs, and optimized inbound and outbound shipping — a supply chain that could scale with pandemic demand instead of straining under it.

KEY INSIGHTS

A leading U.S. plastics distributor partnered with FreightPOP to streamline their supply chain during COVID-19 — replacing a TMS that lacked multimodal visibility and efficient rate-shopping, and drove costs higher.

FreightPOP's platform provided full supply chain visibility, automated workflows, and seamless integration. Results included immediate cost savings, improved internal communication, and optimized inbound and outbound shipping — enabling the customer to scale and enhance operations efficiently.



Have questions?
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